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DESIGN DIRECTOR × DESIGN ENGINEER // DENVER, CO

Ben Mercuri

A design director who **codes**, builds with **AI**, and leads **teams**. 15 years of product, marketing, and brand — drawing the system and shipping the code.

15+	12	8	30+
YEARS IN DESIGN	DIRECT REPORTS LED	HIRES MADE	PROTOTYPES SHIPPED

001 / Profile

// 15 yrs product, marketing & brand. denver, co.

Experienced product design leader driven by tackling complex design challenges and turning ambiguity into clear, elegant solutions. Skilled at leading cross-functional teams through deep discovery and ideation to uncover user insights and shape innovative, user-centered experiences. Adept at breaking down intricate systems into intuitive, scalable designs and guiding product managers, researchers, and content designers toward alignment. Expert in advanced Figma workflows—component libraries, design tokens, variables, and interactive prototypes—enabling rapid iteration and robust design systems.

002 / Looking for

// hybrid leadership · hands-on · build & ship

A hybrid leadership position that balances mentorship and hands-on design work. This role provides opportunities to guide and grow designers while remaining deeply involved in shaping user experiences and product strategy. Collaborate closely with product managers, engineers, and researchers to align design solutions with business goals and technical realities.

003 / Experience

8 roles · 15+ yrs

[01] sefia-consulting

May 2024 — Present

Director, UX/UI Design

Shapes and drives the user-experience practice across diverse client engagements, transforming complex problems into elegant, human-centered solutions.

- **Research-Driven Design** ›
Lead end-to-end discovery and design—user research, journey mapping, prototyping, and usability testing—to create intuitive, accessible interfaces that meet WCAG standards.
- **Vision & Execution** ›
Blend strategic thinking with hands-on craft to define product direction while ensuring every interaction is both functional and delightful.

[02] bearded-spruce-llc

Oct 2023 — Apr 2025

UX-Driven General Contractor & Experience Designer

Pivoted from leading UX design teams to bringing digital-era problem solving into the built environment, crafting spaces that are as intuitive as they are inspiring.

- **Human-Centered Vision** ›
Apply design-thinking principles and deep empathy to uncover how people live and work, transforming those insights into functional, beautiful spaces.
- **Concept-to-Completion Execution** ›
Oversee projects from initial concept through final build, blending creative vision with meticulous attention to detail and quality craftsmanship.
- **Cross-Disciplinary Leadership** ›
Unite clients, architects, and trades through clear communication and collaborative problem solving to deliver spaces that delight and perform.

[03] agora-data

Jan 2022 — Sept 2023

Product Design Manager

Led and mentored a team of product designers to craft AI-driven business-intelligence tools that empower customers to unlock data-backed success.

- **End-to-End Design Leadership** ›
Guided the full product design lifecycle—from ideation and wireframes to high-fidelity prototypes, user testing, front-end handoff, and analytics tracking.
- **Design System Stewardship** ›
Built and maintained a flexible, unified design system that elevated quality and consistency while giving designers room for creative exploration.
- **Hands-On Contribution** ›
Balanced leadership with active design work, ensuring both the team's growth and the craft's excellence.

[04] bertram-capital

Jul 2015 – Dec 2021

Lead Product Designer

Owned the end-to-end creation of exceptional digital experiences—from client discovery through final build.

- Human-Centered Discovery ›
Began every project by listening deeply to client needs and goals, translating them into clear strategies and site plans.
- Design Execution ›
Guided the full design process—wireframes, UI design, and collaborative development oversight—to maintain the integrity and quality of the final product.
- Team Building & Mentorship ›
Hired and mentored internal design teams for client organizations, ensuring that excellence continued long after project handoff.

[05] faction-media

Apr 2014 – Jul 2015

Art Director & Lead Product Designer

Led a multidisciplinary creative team delivering content and digital experiences for Fortune 500 companies—from concept through launch.

- End-to-End Creative Direction ›
Oversaw wire-framing, responsive web and app design, branding, and video art direction, ensuring cohesive, high-impact outcomes.
- Team Leadership ›
Managed and mentored designers throughout the creative process, fostering collaboration and elevating the team's craft.
- Strategic Problem-Solving ›
Went beyond fulfilling client requests—uncovered root challenges and delivered innovative, user-centered solutions that surpassed expectations.

[06] craftsy

Mar 2013 – Apr 2014

Interactive Designer

Pushed online and email creative to the next level—integrating video, animation, and design to envelope the digital world with concise, fun creative.

[07] mapmyfitness

Sep 2012 – Jan 2013

Graphic Designer

Spearheaded, concepted, and designed sales pitches to integrate brand takeovers for the MapMyFitness site. Partners included Starbucks and Brooks Shoes. Developed infographics to assist in sales initiatives and bring in new clientele.

[08] crocs

May 2010 – May 2012

UI Designer

Designed & developed email/landing pages for marketing campaigns and reported on analytics to track success metrics. Assisted in product and lifestyle photography.

004 / Education

Robert Morris University — Illinois

2008 – 2010

Bachelor of Applied Science, Graphic Design

005 / Tools

- Figma
- React
- Tailwind
- Claude
- TypeScript
- Storybook
- HTML
- CSS

006 / Practice

- Design Systems
- Figma (Advanced)
- Component Libraries
- Design Tokens
- Prototyping
- User Research
- Journey Mapping
- Usability Testing
- WCAG / Accessibility
- Cross-functional Leadership
- Mentorship
- Product Strategy